

SOUTH CAROLINA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

CLTC AREA OFFICE HOME AGAIN POLICY

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01.10 INTRODUCTION

The Home Again program is designed to help individuals who reside in nursing facilities return to their homes and communities as part of the Money Follows the Person Rebalancing initiative, funded through the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. The South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services started to implement the program in January, 2013 and has assisted 18 individuals to return to their homes and communities as of December 31, 2013.

Home Again participants are followed for 365 days from the date of Nursing Facility discharge. Home Again participants are eligible for Community Long Term Care (CLTC) Waiver services in addition to Home Again specific services which include Transition Coordination and Expanded Goods and Services. Waiver services will be available to continue to support eligible individuals to remain in the community after the 365 days as long as the individual meets Waiver eligibility.

This policy contains information specific to the Home Again Program. Otherwise, policy is to be followed as outlined in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual.

01.20 POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

01.21 Referral

Follow Policy as outlined in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual.

01.22 Centralized Intake

Follow Policy as outlined in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual. All of the following requirements must be met in order for a referral to be considered appropriate. To be eligible for the program, an applicant must:

- Currently reside in a skilled nursing facility
- Have been in the skilled nursing facility for at least 90 consecutive days
- Be on a Medicaid payment for at least one day prior to discharge
- Meet nursing facility Level of Care, either intermediate or skilled

NOTE: A person cannot count Skilled Rehabilitation Services via their Medicare Part A benefit as part of the 90 day requirement. The person can count hospital stays as part of the 90 days but the person should be re-admitted into the nursing facility at the time of transition. The last day of nursing facility payment should be with Medicaid.

01.23 Eligibility Packet

Once the referral is processed through Intake, Home Again staff will send the Home Again Eligibility Packet to the nursing facility. The nursing facility should return the completed packet information within **14 calendar days** by fax at 803-255-8209.

If Home Again staff does not receive the packet within 14 calendar days, the application will be terminated. Home Again worker will send out Community Long Term Care Notification Form to the referral source, participant and/or primary contact if the application is closed.

Once an applicant meets the eligibility requirements of the Home Again program, Home Again staff determines a priority for the case, either 1) regular case or 2) expedited case, and transfers the case to the appropriate Community Long Term Care Area Office.

01.24 Assessment

01.24.10 Timeliness Standards

An applicant for the program must be seen within **14 calendar days** of referral.

NOTE: If a case is determined as an expedited case, the applicant for the program must be seen within **five calendar days**.

01.24.20 Consent

The Consent Form must be signed by the applicant or a primary contact.

NOTE: If the participant is under custody of DSS, the DSS case worker may sign the form.

01.24.30 Locus

The CLTC Participant Service Choice should be obtained indicating the applicant's desire regarding program participation, and their choice of Locus. If an applicant is residing out-of-state and intends to move to South Carolina, the CLTC Participant Service Choice may be done verbally.

NOTE: If the applicant is under custody of DSS, the DSS case worker may sign the Form.

01.24.40 Assessment

The Assessment will be completed by the nurse consultant. The Area Office assigns the application to a nurse consultant. Timeliness standard for Level of Care determination is **five calendar days** upon the receipt of a completed Assessment.

NOTE: If a case is determined as an expedited case, timeliness standard for Level of Care determination is **three calendar days** upon the receipt of a completed Assessment.

During the visit, the nurse consultant obtains the choice of provider for **Transition Coordination Visit**. The nurse consultant completes the Assessment Section and Medication Section in Phoenix. The nurse consultant does NOT complete the Home Assessment Section, Caregiver Support Section or Non-Waiver Supports Section.

The Assessment and Level of Care date MUST be within 30 days of entry into the program. If the Assessment or Level of Care is older than 30 days, a new Assessment must be completed and a Level of Care must be determined and entered into Phoenix. This re-assessment may be completed by phone. If it appears the applicant is medically ineligible, a visit is required.

01.25 Medical Eligibility Criteria

The Home Again program utilizes nursing facility Level of Care. The applicant must meet the established Level of Care which is skilled or intermediate nursing facility Level of Care.

If the applicant is determined to be medically ineligible after receiving physician's input, the nurse consultant will close the application and mail CLTC notification form 171 along with the appeals Notification.

The nurse consultant will notify Home Again staff at homeagain@scdhhs.gov if the application is closed.

01.26 Financial Eligibility

Financial eligibility (Medicaid) must be established before a participant can be admitted to the program. Follow Policy as outlined in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual to establish/verify Medicaid eligibility.

01.27 Case Management

If the participant is determined to be medically and financially eligible, the nurse consultant discusses and transfers the application to the case manager II. The case manager II should make a referral for **Transition Coordination Visit** and notifies the providers of the referral by call or email. When the provider accepts the referral, the case manager II should list the provider as Transition Coordinator in the Home Again Application and complete the Transition Coordination Visit authorization, **the rate is \$0**.

The case manager II should NOT make a referral or authorization for Transition Coordination. This service is the payment to transition coordinator providers and will be handled exclusively by Home Again staff.

01.27.10 Table 1540

Home Again program utilizes Table 1540 rather than Recipient Special Program (RSP) to pay Home Again claims. The case manager II should email Home Again staff at homeagain@scdhhs.gov and include the following information within **three calendar days** upon Level of Care determination:

- Participant's Name
- Medicaid Number
- Home Again Start Date
- Home Again End Date

The Home Again Start Date is the date of the Level of Care determination. The Home Again End date is the 365th day after the participant is discharged from the nursing facility. If the Area Office does not know when the participant will be discharged from the facility, the case manager II may use the 365th day from the Start Date.

The case manager II is also responsible to notify Home Again staff once the applicant is discharged from the facility and/or if the application is terminated to update the End Date.

01.28 Pre-transition Planning

The transition coordinator makes initial visit to the nursing facility to confirm the discharge date and complete Risk Assessment within **10 calendar days**.

NOTE: If the case is determined as an expedited case, the transition coordinator completes the process within **three calendar days**.

If the Home Again Assessment deems the situation inappropriate or unsafe, the transition coordinator terminates the Transition Coordination Visit authorization and the Home Again application. A Notification is sent to the referral source, participant and/or primary contact. The Home Again staff and the case manager II will also be notified.

If the transition coordinator determines the transition to be appropriate, the transition coordinator follows and completes the Transition Checklist under the Home Again carousel in Phoenix. Once housing in the community has been identified, the transition coordinator conducts a Quality of Life survey and home visit to assess the participant's needs.

01.29 Service Plan

If the Home Again Assessment is deemed as appropriate, the transition coordinator notifies the case manager II. The case manager II completes Service Plan within **seven calendar days** of the notification. The Service Plan should be completed prior to the transition and while the participant continues to be on the waiting list.

NOTE: If the case is determined as an expedited case, the case manager II completes Service Plan within **two calendar days** of the notification.

As part of the Medicaid verification process for program enrollment, it must be determined through RSP that the recipient is not participating in any other special programs. If RSP indicates a managed care program that does not overlap with CLTC program, the case manager II should inform the participant and/or primary contact. The participant and/or primary contact will decide whether or not to discontinue the managed care program in order to participate in the Home Again program. The case manager II will notify designated state worker to dis-enroll the participant from the managed care program, if applicable.

01.30 Service Authorization

The case manager II obtains provider choices and completes referrals and authorizations for Waiver services within **five calendar days** once the Service Plan is completed. The case manager II calls potential providers to accelerate the process, if necessary. The earliest the authorization start date should be is the date of discharge.

NOTE: If the case is determined as an expedited case, the case manager II obtains **verbal provider** choices and completes referrals and authorizations for Waiver services within **two calendar days** once the Service Plan is completed.

01.31 Enrolling into Home Again

Once the discharge occurs, case manager II moves the participant to the **participating** status in Phoenix, effective date must be the **discharge date**, and transfers the case to the case management provider. **No RSP** is entered in MMIS. The case manager II also notifies Eligibility worker to change the Medicaid pay category by Eligibility Workflow in Phoenix.

01.32 Monitoring

The case management provider completes the Initial Visit within 30 days of enrollment. During the initial visit, the case management provider completes the Home Assessment and Caregiver Supports sections in Phoenix. Follow Policy as outlined in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual for on-going case management.

01.33 Termination

Follow Policy as outlined in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual for termination.

01.34 Transferring after 365 days

Three weeks prior to the Home Again End Date, the Transition Coordinator creates a new referral for CLTC Wavier and sends an email notification of the referral, including the Home Again End Date, to the Area Administrator. The transition coordinator will copy Home Again staff and Central Office Policy Liaison in the email. The Transition Coordinator also completes Quality of Life survey.

Centralized Intake nurse completes phone Assessment and transfers the case to the appropriate Area Office.

Area Office assigns a nurse consultant. The nurse consultant completes the re-evaluation within **14 calendar days** from the assignment. The assigned nurse consultant may complete the CLTC Assessment by phone if the last Assessment was completed within 180 days. An in-home visit is required if the Assessment is over 180 days old or if it appears the applicant is medically ineligible. New Consent and Locus choice forms should be obtained either verbally or during home visit; however, new provider choice forms are not required.

The nurse consultant transfers the case to case manager II.

The transition coordinator terminates the Transition Coordination Visit authorization and the Home Again application on the Home Again End Date. Authorizations for services which will continue under CLTC Waiver will remain active, except Case Management Contact and Case Management Visit authorizations. The transition

coordinator also sends out a Notification Form to the participant and/or primary contact, without the Appeals Rights.

The case manager II will create new authorizations for CMC and CMV for the same provider. The case manager II changes the Waiver application status to participating on the day following the Home Again End Date. For example, if the person terminates Home Again on 01/15/14 and the start date of Waiver participation should be 01/16/14.

The designated state worker will complete RSP entry for the following day of the Home Again End Date.

Following enrollment, normal Community Long Term Care Policies and Procedures are should be followed.

01.35 Out-of-State Referral

The receiving CLTC Area Office should follow CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual to evaluate the applicant who is residing outside of South Carolina but is seeking to be relocated to South Carolina via the Home Again program.

In response to contact from out of state nursing facility, the nurse consultant sends Assessment and Consent Form, DHHS Form 121 to the facility to complete and return to the Office. The Assessment must be completed by a professional staff member in the out-of-state facility and sent to CLTC with the completed Consent Form, DHHS Form 121, for review.

The nurse consultant must contact the out-of-state facility by telephone upon receipt of the Assessment to validate the information for the tentative Level of Care after team conference per policy.

The applicant and/or primary contact, out-of-state facility, and Home Again staff must be informed of the tentative Level of Care on the CLTC Notification, using the comment section.

If the applicant is seeking housing options in South Carolina, the applicant should stay on the Home Again waiting list no more than 6 months. If the applicant has been in the waiting list more than 6 months, Transition Coordinator will close the application and send a CLTC Notification to applicant and/or primary contact, out-of-state facility.

NOTE: The applicant may stay in the waiting list more than 6 months with Home Again staff's approval.

Once the applicant meets tentative Level of Care, the nurse consultant will transfer the case to case manager II. The transition coordinator will assist the applicant to locate

housing in South Carolina. When housing is identified, the transition coordinator will notify the case manager II the potential discharge date. The transition coordinator and the case manager II will discuss Service Plan and service needs. The case manager II will obtain verbal provider choices based on the tentative Service Plan. The case manager II may contact potential providers to determine availability prior to the discharge date.

The transition coordinator will ensure that all South Carolina Medicaid financial eligibility documentation has been submitted at least **10 calendar days** prior to the discharge date.

The final Level of Care must be determined through a visit to the applicant's residency within **two calendar days**, excluding holidays and weekends, of the applicant's relocation to South Carolina.

If the applicant does not meet Level of Care, the application/case will be closed in Phoenix as "medically ineligible". If the applicant meets Level of Care, follow the procedures in this policy.

If the applicant does meet Level of Care, the case manager II will ensure that the South Carolina Medicaid number is entered into Phoenix and MMIS. The case manager II will start referral process within **two calendar days**, excluding holidays and weekends, from the time that Medicaid eligibility determined.

Questions and Answers regarding Home Again Policies and Procedures:

1. How do we know if an applicant meets the preliminary requirements of the program?
Once a referral is made, Home Again staff contacts and asks the nursing facility to fill out the Home Again Eligibility Packet. And the Home Again staff uploads the document in “Scans” tab in Phoenix. The Home Again staff also completes narrative and sends out an email notification to the appropriate Area Office.
2. How can the case manager II check if the transition coordinator is listed in the Home Again application?
Go to Phoenix > click “Application” tab > click “Home Again” > look for Transition Coordinator under “General” tab. If the transition coordinator is not listed, the case manager II should click “Edit” from the application and select the transition coordinator from the drop down box. If this process has not been done, the transition coordinator will not be able to see the participant in their Dashboard in Phoenix.
3. Can case manager II make a referral/authorization for “Transition Coordination Visit” before Service Plan set up?
Yes, Transition Coordination Visit does not require Service Plan to make the referral and authorization. The role of transition coordinator is to help with any discharge planning. In order to do that, the provider should start to provide the service before the participant is discharged. Go to Phoenix > click “Waiver Supports” tab > click “New Referral” > and then choose Transition Coordination Visit.
4. Should case manager II make a referral/authorization for “Transition Coordination”?
No, Home Again staff in central office will ensure this part.
5. We do not have any transition coordinators available in our area. What do we do?
Home Again Transition Coordination Manager will appear as a provider choice where there are no contracted providers for Transition Coordination Visit.
6. How case manager II ensures that the applicant is in Table 1540?
The case manager II should email Home Again staff at homeagain@scdhhs.gov with the applicant’s name, Medicaid number, Start Date, and End Date.
7. The case manager II has made a request for addition of the participant to Table 1540 but has not received the confirmation email yet. Should case manager II wait to hear back from the point person to proceed the next step?
No, the case manager II should go ahead and proceed with the next step as soon as the request has been made.
8. Can case manager II complete a Service Plain while a participant is on the waiting list?
Yes, the necessary changes to the Phoenix have been made and the case manager II should complete the Service Plan while the participant is on the waiting list.
9. Nurse consultant transferred the case to the case manager II and the case is not moving forward because there is no housing identified. Is it okay to have the Home Again case open for several months?

Yes, it is part of discharge planning and it will take some time to locate housing unless the participant has a place to go. The case manager II should NOT get any penalty for having the case for a longer period of time.

10. The Home Assessment has not been done because the participant was at nursing facility when the nurse consultant went out to see the person. Who is responsible to complete the Home Assessment?

Case management provider is responsible for Home Assessment.

11. Can a Home Again participant be enrolled with MCO during the first 365 days once they have transitioned to the community?

No, dual-enrollment with MCO is not allowed with the Home Again program at this time. Home Again will work with SC Prime for dually eligible participants. Additional policy guidance will be issued at a later date.

12. Can a Ramp provider build a ramp before the discharge date?

Yes, the case manager II should make a referral to Ramp providers through Phoenix once the need is identified. The case manager II should call the Ramp provider and explain that the reimbursement will occur once the participant is discharged from a nursing facility. The authorization should be made prior to the discharge date. The authorization start date should be either discharge date or any time after the discharge date.

13. Can case manager II wait to do Service Plan, referrals, and authorizations until a participant is discharged?

No. Service Plan, referrals, and authorizations should be done prior to the discharge date, except out of state cases

14. How case manager II start referral and authorization process prior to moving the applicant to the participating list?

Home Again referrals and authorizations can be initiated from the "Waiver Supports" tab. Go to Phoenix > click "Waiver Supports" tab > click "New Referral" button.